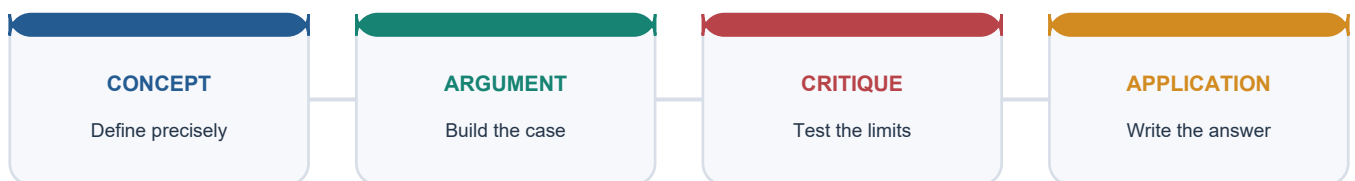


SOLVED PRACTICE WORKBOOK

Land Reforms, Green Revolution and Cropping Systems - Solved Practice Workbook

Economy | UPSC Prelims and GS-III

LEARNING PATH



Deterministic fallback visual: move from precise concepts through argument and critique to exam application.

Source order: repository knowledge -> official current linkage -> clearly marked analysis. No fabricated PYQs or statistics.

CONTENTS / WORKBOOK INDEX

Major learning parts and meaningful subtopics are listed in document order. Page numbers are generated from the final PDF layout; PDF bookmarks mirror the same hierarchy.

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Land Reforms, Green Revolution and Cropping Systems - Solved Practice Workbook

Exactly 32 original questions appear before PYQs. Correct answers rotate A -> B -> C -> D eight times.

BASIC MCQS / REMEDIATION

MCQ 1

Which option best defines the scope of land reform?

A. It includes intermediary abolition, tenancy, ceilings, consolidation and records. B. It refers only to redistribution of ceiling-surplus land. C. It means replacing private farms with State farms. D. It is identical to the introduction of high-yielding seeds.

Answer: A.

Option-wise explanation:

- **A - Correct:** The correct option states the complete institutional package. The option states: It includes intermediary abolition, tenancy, ceilings, consolidation and records.
- **B - Incorrect:** Redistribution is only one instrument. The option states: It refers only to redistribution of ceiling-surplus land.
- **C - Incorrect:** Collectivisation is not the general Indian definition. The option states: It means replacing private farms with State farms.
- **D - Incorrect:** Seed technology belongs to the Green Revolution, not land reform. The option states: It is identical to the introduction of high-yielding seeds.

Examiner trap 1: Do not reduce land reform to one redistributive instrument.

MCQ 2

Under the zamindari arrangement, which relationship is central?

A. The State assessed every cultivator directly without any recognised intermediary. B. A recognised intermediary stood between the State and actual cultivators for revenue or rent. C. A village estate alone held collective revenue responsibility everywhere. D. The arrangement guaranteed ownership to every tenant.

Answer: B.

Option-wise explanation:

- **A - Incorrect:** This describes the ryotwari ideal, not zamindari. The option states: The State assessed every cultivator directly without any recognised intermediary.
- **B - Correct:** Zamindari institutionalised a rent-receiving intermediary layer. The option states: A recognised intermediary stood between the State and actual cultivators for revenue or rent.
- **C - Incorrect:** This is closer to mahalwari logic. The option states: A village estate alone held collective revenue responsibility everywhere.
- **D - Incorrect:** Tenancy ownership did not follow automatically. The option states: The arrangement guaranteed ownership to every tenant.

Examiner trap 2: Intermediary status must not be confused with cultivator ownership.

MCQ 3

Which statement correctly qualifies ryotwari settlement?

A. It vested the whole village jointly in a zamindar. B. It abolished colonial land revenue. C. It involved direct assessment of the recorded cultivator but did not guarantee low demand or conclusive title. D. It made all tenants permanent owners after Independence.

Answer: C.

Option-wise explanation:

- **A - Incorrect:** Ryotwari did not rely on a single zamindar for the principal assessment. The option states: It vested the whole village jointly in a zamindar.
- **B - Incorrect:** Colonial revenue continued under ryotwari. The option states: It abolished colonial land revenue.
- **C - Correct:** Direct settlement and secure ownership are analytically distinct. The option states: It involved direct assessment of the recorded cultivator but did not guarantee low demand or conclusive title.
- **D - Incorrect:** Post-Independence tenancy outcomes depended on State laws. The option states: It made all tenants permanent owners after Independence.

Examiner trap 3: Direct State-cultivator contact is not proof of secure tenure.

MCQ 4

Mahalwari settlement is best identified by:

A. A universal cash grant to landless labourers. B. A direct settlement with each ryot in all of India. C. A permanent State purchase of every estate. D. Revenue responsibility associated with a village estate, mahal or co-sharer body.

Answer: D.

Option-wise explanation:

- **A - Incorrect:** It was a revenue system, not a welfare transfer. The option states: A universal cash grant to landless labourers.
- **B - Incorrect:** This overstates ryotwari and ignores regional variation. The option states: A direct settlement with each ryot in all of India.
- **C - Incorrect:** Assessment did not mean universal State ownership. The option states: A permanent State purchase of every estate.
- **D - Correct:** The mahal or village estate was the relevant assessment unit. The option states: Revenue responsibility associated with a village estate, mahal or co-sharer body.

Examiner trap 4: Village responsibility did not imply an egalitarian village.

MCQ 5

What was the direct institutional objective of intermediary abolition?

A. To extinguish specified rent-receiving layers between the State and cultivator. B. To consolidate every fragmented holding. C. To introduce semi-dwarf wheat. D. To nationalise all agricultural land.

Answer: A.

Option-wise explanation:

- **A - Correct:** Abolition de-layered the revenue and tenure hierarchy. The option states: To extinguish specified rent-receiving layers between the State and cultivator.
- **B - Incorrect:** Consolidation is a separate parcel-reorganisation measure. The option states: To consolidate every fragmented holding.
- **C - Incorrect:** Semi-dwarf wheat belongs to the Green Revolution. The option states: To introduce semi-dwarf wheat.
- **D - Incorrect:** Indian reform generally did not nationalise all farmland. The option states: To nationalise all agricultural land.

Examiner trap 5: Abolition did not settle all sub-tenancy and title questions.

MCQ 6

Tenancy reform ordinarily includes which bundle?

A. Only a ban on all leasing. B. Rent regulation, tenure security, recording and possible ownership rights under State law. C. Only compensation to former zamindars. D. Only cadastral-map digitisation.

Answer: B.

Option-wise explanation:

- **A - Incorrect:** Blanket prohibition can drive tenancy underground. The option states: Only a ban on all leasing.
- **B - Correct:** The bundle captures protection, recognition and possible ownership. The option states: Rent regulation, tenure security, recording and possible ownership rights under State law.
- **C - Incorrect:** Intermediary compensation is a different issue. The option states: Only compensation to former zamindars.
- **D - Incorrect:** Digitisation supports records but is not the whole tenancy reform. The option states: Only cadastral-map digitisation.

Examiner trap 6: Do not equate tenancy reform with prohibition alone.

MCQ 7

Which statement about land ceilings is correct?

A. They merge scattered parcels without changing ownership. B. They automatically transfer every leased plot to its tenant. C. They set a State-law maximum and identify legally surplus land, subject to units and exemptions. D. They are fixed uniformly by one Union statute.

Answer: C.

Option-wise explanation:

- **A - Incorrect:** This describes consolidation. The option states: They merge scattered parcels without changing ownership.
- **B - Incorrect:** Tenant ownership depends on separate State provisions. The option states: They automatically transfer every leased plot to its tenant.
- **C - Correct:** Ceilings operate through State definitions of permissible and surplus holdings. The option states: They set a State-law maximum and identify legally surplus land, subject to units and exemptions.
- **D - Incorrect:** Land is principally a State legislative field. The option states: They are fixed uniformly by one Union statute.

Examiner trap 7: Declared surplus is not the same as land possessed and distributed.

MCQ 8

Consolidation of holdings primarily seeks to:

A. Redistribute every holding above a ceiling. B. Create conclusive title merely by scanning records. C. Prohibit all machinery services. D. Reorganise scattered parcels into fewer workable blocks without necessarily changing total ownership.

Answer: D.

Option-wise explanation:

- **A - Incorrect:** Redistribution is the ceiling function. The option states: Redistribute every holding above a ceiling.
- **B - Incorrect:** Digitisation cannot itself settle title. The option states: Create conclusive title merely by scanning records.
- **C - Incorrect:** Machinery services may complement consolidation. The option states: Prohibit all machinery services.

- **D - Correct:** Consolidation addresses spatial fragmentation and operating costs. The option states: Reorganise scattered parcels into fewer workable blocks without necessarily changing total ownership.

Examiner trap 8: Consolidation is neither collectivisation nor ceiling redistribution.

MCQ 9

Bhoodan differed from statutory ceiling reform because it relied on:

A. Voluntary land gifts mobilised through Vinoba Bhave's movement. B. Compulsory acquisition under a uniform Union ceiling. C. Drone mapping of rural abadi land. D. Procurement of wheat at administered prices.

Answer: A.

Option-wise explanation:

- **A - Correct:** Bhoodan used moral persuasion and voluntary donation. The option states: Voluntary land gifts mobilised through Vinoba Bhave's movement.
- **B - Incorrect:** Ceiling acquisition was State-law based, not a single Union ceiling. The option states: Compulsory acquisition under a uniform Union ceiling.
- **C - Incorrect:** Drone mapping belongs to SVAMITVA. The option states: Drone mapping of rural abadi land.
- **D - Incorrect:** Procurement belongs to food management. The option states: Procurement of wheat at administered prices.

Examiner trap 9: Pledged, transferred and cultivable land are separate quantities.

MCQ 10

Why did land-reform outcomes vary substantially among States?

A. The Constitution barred States from legislating on land. B. Land is principally in the State List and implementation capacity and politics differed. C. Every State used an identical law and record system. D. Only rainfall determined reform success.

Answer: B.

Option-wise explanation:

- **A - Incorrect:** State List Entry 18 points the other way. The option states: The Constitution barred States from legislating on land.
- **B - Correct:** Federal competence combined with political and administrative variation. The option states: Land is principally in the State List and implementation capacity and politics differed.
- **C - Incorrect:** State laws and institutions differed. The option states: Every State used an identical law and record system.
- **D - Incorrect:** Rainfall cannot explain legal implementation alone. The option states: Only rainfall determined reform success.

Examiner trap 10: A national reform label conceals State-level design.

MCQ 11

Article 31A primarily matters to agrarian reform because it:

A. Places every land law in the Ninth Schedule automatically. B. Transfers land legislation to Parliament. C. Protects specified categories such as estate acquisition or rights modification on stated constitutional grounds. D. Eliminates all judicial review of reform laws.

Answer: C.

Option-wise explanation:

- **A - Incorrect:** Article 31B requires specific Ninth-Schedule listing. The option states: Places every land law in the Ninth Schedule automatically.
- **B - Incorrect:** Land remains principally a State subject. The option states: Transfers land legislation to Parliament.

- **C - Correct:** Article 31A is a category-specific constitutional shield. The option states: Protects specified categories such as estate acquisition or rights modification on stated constitutional grounds.
- **D - Incorrect:** Textual conditions and constitutional review remain. The option states: Eliminates all judicial review of reform laws.

Examiner trap 11: Article 31A is not blanket immunity.

MCQ 12

Which statement about Article 31B is correct?

A. It applies automatically to all Directive Principles. B. It defines cropping intensity. C. It makes every post-1973 insertion immune from review. D. It protects laws specifically listed in the Ninth Schedule, subject to the basic-structure qualification.

Answer: D.

Option-wise explanation:

- **A - Incorrect:** Article 31C, not 31B, concerns Article 39(b) and (c). The option states: It applies automatically to all Directive Principles.
- **B - Incorrect:** Cropping intensity is a land-use statistic. The option states: It defines cropping intensity.
- **C - Incorrect:** I.R. Coelho preserves basic-structure review. The option states: It makes every post-1973 insertion immune from review.
- **D - Correct:** Article 31B works through specific Schedule listing. The option states: It protects laws specifically listed in the Ninth Schedule, subject to the basic-structure qualification.

Examiner trap 12: Ninth-Schedule listing is law-specific, not subject-wide.

MCQ 13

In its operative scope, Article 31C protects laws implementing:

A. Article 39(b) or 39(c), subject to constitutional interpretation. B. Every Directive Principle without limit. C. Only land-record computerisation. D. Only laws enacted before 1951.

Answer: A.

Option-wise explanation:

- **A - Correct:** The surviving protection is tied to material-resource and anti-concentration clauses. The option states: Article 39(b) or 39(c), subject to constitutional interpretation.
- **B - Incorrect:** The all-Directive-Principles extension did not survive review. The option states: Every Directive Principle without limit.
- **C - Incorrect:** DILRMP is a programme, not Article 31C's definition. The option states: Only land-record computerisation.
- **D - Incorrect:** Article 31C is not confined to pre-1951 laws. The option states: Only laws enacted before 1951.

Examiner trap 13: State the Article 39(b)/(c) boundary.

MCQ 14

What is the core holding relevant from I.R. Coelho (2007)?

A. Every Ninth-Schedule law was automatically repealed. B. Post-24 April 1973 Ninth-Schedule insertions can be reviewed for basic-structure damage. C. Land ceilings became a Union subject. D. Article 31A was deleted.

Answer: B.

Option-wise explanation:

- **A - Incorrect:** The judgment created review, not automatic repeal. The option states: Every Ninth-Schedule law was automatically repealed.
- **B - Correct:** The Court preserved basic-structure review after the Kesavananda cut-off. The option states: Post-24 April 1973 Ninth-Schedule insertions can be reviewed for basic-structure damage.

- **C - Incorrect:** The federal allocation of land did not change. The option states: Land ceilings became a Union subject.
- **D - Incorrect:** Article 31A remains in the Constitution. The option states: Article 31A was deleted.

Examiner trap 14: Ninth-Schedule protection is not a constitutional black hole.

MCQ 15

Which reform most directly strengthens women's effective land rights?

A. Counting household land only in the male head's name. B. Treating statutory shares as self-executing. C. Combining legal inheritance equality with mutation, possession and control over farm decisions. D. Replacing all State records with an undifferentiated family record.

Answer: C.

Option-wise explanation:

- **A - Incorrect:** Male-only recording erases women's claims. The option states: Counting household land only in the male head's name.
- **B - Incorrect:** Mutation and possession remain necessary. The option states: Treating statutory shares as self-executing.
- **C - Correct:** Effective rights require the legal share to appear in enforceable records and control. The option states: Combining legal inheritance equality with mutation, possession and control over farm decisions.
- **D - Incorrect:** Household aggregation can conceal individual entitlements. The option states: Replacing all State records with an undifferentiated family record.

Examiner trap 15: Formal equality and effective control are different.

MCQ 16

Why must tribal and customary tenure be mapped carefully?

A. Unrecorded commons are automatically ownerless. B. All Scheduled Areas follow one private-title law. C. Digitisation lawfully extinguishes every customary claim. D. Private parcels, community use and anti-alienation protections may coexist.

Answer: D.

Option-wise explanation:

- **A - Incorrect:** Lack of an individual entry does not prove absence of rights. The option states: Unrecorded commons are automatically ownerless.
- **B - Incorrect:** Constitutional and State arrangements vary. The option states: All Scheduled Areas follow one private-title law.
- **C - Incorrect:** Technology cannot extinguish lawful claims without due process. The option states: Digitisation lawfully extinguishes every customary claim.
- **D - Correct:** Multiple rights can attach to land beyond an individual ownership entry. The option states: Private parcels, community use and anti-alienation protections may coexist.

Examiner trap 16: Do not equate unrecorded community land with vacant land.

MCQ 17

The NITI Aayog Model Agricultural Land Leasing Act, 2016 sought to:

A. Enable lawful leasing while protecting both ownership and cultivator interests. B. Transfer ownership automatically to every lessee. C. Create a binding all-India tenancy code. D. Prohibit written agricultural leases.

Answer: A.

Option-wise explanation:

- **A - Correct:** The model balances owner security with recorded cultivation. The option states: Enable lawful leasing while protecting both ownership and cultivator interests.

- **B - Incorrect:** A lease is not an ownership transfer. The option states: Transfer ownership automatically to every lessee.
- **C - Incorrect:** The model is advisory for State adaptation. The option states: Create a binding all-India tenancy code.
- **D - Incorrect:** Written contracts are part of the proposed formalisation. The option states: Prohibit written agricultural leases.

Examiner trap 17: A model law does not itself amend State law.

MCQ 18

Which statement best describes DILRMP?

A. It is solely a crop-insurance programme. B. It modernises textual and spatial records and their integration; it does not itself guarantee title. C. It abolishes State land departments. D. It covers only urban stock-exchange property.

Answer: B.

Option-wise explanation:

- **A - Incorrect:** Crop insurance is a different policy field. The option states: It is solely a crop-insurance programme.
- **B - Correct:** DILRMP is land-information infrastructure implemented through States and Union Territories. The option states: It modernises textual and spatial records and their integration; it does not itself guarantee title.
- **C - Incorrect:** States remain central implementers. The option states: It abolishes State land departments.
- **D - Incorrect:** The programme concerns land records, not securities markets. The option states: It covers only urban stock-exchange property.

Examiner trap 18: Digitisation and conclusive titling are different reforms.

MCQ 19

ULPIN or Bhu-Aadhaar is:

A. A biometric identity number for the cultivator. B. An automatic court decree on ownership. C. A 14-digit alphanumeric identifier for a georeferenced land parcel. D. A guaranteed farm-credit limit.

Answer: C.

Option-wise explanation:

- **A - Incorrect:** It identifies land, not a person. The option states: A biometric identity number for the cultivator.
- **B - Incorrect:** Competing rights still require legal process. The option states: An automatic court decree on ownership.
- **C - Correct:** ULPIN identifies the parcel to support interoperable records. The option states: A 14-digit alphanumeric identifier for a georeferenced land parcel.
- **D - Incorrect:** Credit eligibility is not fixed by the identifier. The option states: A guaranteed farm-credit limit.

Examiner trap 19: Parcel identification does not adjudicate every right.

MCQ 20

Which statement correctly bounds SVAMITVA?

A. It surveys every agricultural field nationwide. B. Its card is uniformly an indefeasible Union title deed. C. It replaces cadastral and revenue law in every State. D. It maps rural abadi areas and supports State-issued property cards through survey and objection processes.

Answer: D.

Option-wise explanation:

- **A - Incorrect:** Agricultural fields are not its universal scope. The option states: It surveys every agricultural field nationwide.

- **B - Incorrect:** Legal effect depends on State law. The option states: Its card is uniformly an infeasible Union title deed.
- **C - Incorrect:** The scheme operates with, not above, State legal systems. The option states: It replaces cadastral and revenue law in every State.
- **D - Correct:** SVAMITVA's primary spatial focus is inhabited village abadi property. The option states: It maps rural abadi areas and supports State-issued property cards through survey and objection processes.

Examiner trap 20: A property card is not automatically conclusive title.

MCQ 21

The Green Revolution is most accurately understood as:

A. An HYV-water-fertiliser-credit-extension-procurement package. B. A seed distribution event independent of institutions. C. A uniform shift across every crop and region. D. A land-ceiling programme.

Answer: A.

Option-wise explanation:

- **A - Correct:** Complementary inputs and institutions converted varietal potential into output. The option states: An HYV-water-fertiliser-credit-extension-procurement package.
- **B - Incorrect:** Seed alone cannot explain adoption and realised yield. The option states: A seed distribution event independent of institutions.
- **C - Incorrect:** Initial gains were crop- and region-concentrated. The option states: A uniform shift across every crop and region.
- **D - Incorrect:** Ceilings concern agrarian assets, not crop technology. The option states: A land-ceiling programme.

Examiner trap 21: Never describe it as a seed-only revolution.

MCQ 22

Why were semi-dwarf cereal varieties important?

A. They required no irrigation or nutrients. B. They could respond strongly to nutrients with lower lodging risk under suitable management. C. They guaranteed equal gains in every region. D. They eliminated the need for local breeding and trials.

Answer: B.

Option-wise explanation:

- **A - Incorrect:** HYV performance remained input-dependent. The option states: They required no irrigation or nutrients.
- **B - Correct:** Plant architecture helped convert fertiliser and water into grain. The option states: They could respond strongly to nutrients with lower lodging risk under suitable management.
- **C - Incorrect:** Agro-climatic and institutional conditions differed. The option states: They guaranteed equal gains in every region.
- **D - Incorrect:** Adaptation and seed systems remained essential. The option states: They eliminated the need for local breeding and trials.

Examiner trap 22: High yield is potential under conditions, not an automatic outcome.

MCQ 23

Which statement captures early Green-Revolution concentration?

A. Pulses and oilseeds led uniformly across rainfed India. B. Every district adopted simultaneously. C. Gains were strongest in irrigated north-western wheat areas, with rice spreading later. D. The strategy was independent of procurement and irrigation.

Answer: C.

Option-wise explanation:

- **A - Incorrect:** Pulses and oilseeds were less central initially. The option states: Pulses and oilseeds led uniformly across rainfed India.
- **B - Incorrect:** Diffusion was uneven over time. The option states: Every district adopted simultaneously.
- **C - Correct:** Complementary infrastructure concentrated early adoption geographically and by crop. The option states: Gains were strongest in irrigated north-western wheat areas, with rice spreading later.
- **D - Incorrect:** Irrigation and market support shaped adoption. The option states: The strategy was independent of procurement and irrigation.

Examiner trap 23: National output success can coexist with regional disparity.

MCQ 24

An evergreen-revolution approach emphasises:

A. Repeating input intensification without resource limits. B. Ending all modern crop science. C. Replacing diversification with permanent monoculture. D. Sustained productivity growth with ecological resilience and farmer viability.

Answer: D.

Option-wise explanation:

- **A - Incorrect:** Resource constraints must enter the objective. The option states: Repeating input intensification without resource limits.
- **B - Incorrect:** Science remains central but changes direction. The option states: Ending all modern crop science.
- **C - Incorrect:** Diversity can reduce systemic risk. The option states: Replacing diversification with permanent monoculture.
- **D - Correct:** The concept joins productivity with ecological durability. The option states: Sustained productivity growth with ecological resilience and farmer viability.

Examiner trap 24: Evergreen does not mean an identical second Green Revolution.

MCQ 25

Which season description is correct?

A. Kharif is broadly monsoon-linked, while regional calendars and irrigated exceptions remain. B. Rabi is always sown during peak monsoon. C. Zaid is a permanent plantation category. D. Every pulse belongs only to kharif.

Answer: A.

Option-wise explanation:

- **A - Correct:** Season labels are broad calendars rather than immutable crop identities. The option states: Kharif is broadly monsoon-linked, while regional calendars and irrigated exceptions remain.
- **B - Incorrect:** Rabi is principally the winter season. The option states: Rabi is always sown during peak monsoon.
- **C - Incorrect:** Zaid denotes a short summer cultivation window. The option states: Zaid is a permanent plantation category.
- **D - Incorrect:** Pulses can occur in different seasons by crop and region. The option states: Every pulse belongs only to kharif.

Examiner trap 25: Do not turn common seasons into universal crop rules.

MCQ 26

Cropping intensity equals:

A. Total production divided by rural population. B. Gross cropped area divided by net area sown, multiplied by 100. C. Net area sown divided by gross cropped area without percentage conversion. D. Yield divided by irrigated area.

Answer: B.

Option-wise explanation:

- **A - Incorrect:** This is not a land-use intensity measure. The option states: Total production divided by rural population.
- **B - Correct:** The ratio measures how often net sown land is cropped within the year. The option states: Gross cropped area divided by net area sown, multiplied by 100.
- **C - Incorrect:** The ratio is reversed and incomplete. The option states: Net area sown divided by gross cropped area without percentage conversion.
- **D - Incorrect:** Yield and irrigation are different statistics. The option states: Yield divided by irrigated area.

Examiner trap 26: Cropping intensity measures repeated land use, not yield.

MCQ 27

Which comparison is accurate?

A. Crop rotation means simultaneous sowing of all crops. B. Multiple cropping always means mixed seed in one field. C. Mixed cropping lacks a fixed row geometry, whereas intercropping uses a planned spatial arrangement. D. Intercropping and monoculture are identical.

Answer: C.

Option-wise explanation:

- **A - Incorrect:** Rotation is a temporal sequence. The option states: Crop rotation means simultaneous sowing of all crops.
- **B - Incorrect:** Multiple cropping refers to more than one crop cycle or crop use, not necessarily a mixture. The option states: Multiple cropping always means mixed seed in one field.
- **C - Correct:** Spatial arrangement distinguishes mixed cropping from intercropping. The option states: Mixed cropping lacks a fixed row geometry, whereas intercropping uses a planned spatial arrangement.
- **D - Incorrect:** Intercropping deliberately combines crops. The option states: Intercropping and monoculture are identical.

Examiner trap 27: Do not use mixed cropping and intercropping interchangeably.

MCQ 28

A rise in agricultural production can occur without higher productivity when:

A. Yield rises on unchanged area. B. The same output uses fewer inputs. C. A yield gap narrows. D. Cultivated area expands while yield per hectare is unchanged.

Answer: D.

Option-wise explanation:

- **A - Incorrect:** This is precisely higher land productivity. The option states: Yield rises on unchanged area.
- **B - Incorrect:** Using fewer inputs for the same output raises efficiency. The option states: The same output uses fewer inputs.
- **C - Incorrect:** A narrower yield gap generally implies higher realised productivity. The option states: A yield gap narrows.
- **D - Correct:** Production is area multiplied by yield, so an area effect alone can raise output. The option states: Cultivated area expands while yield per hectare is unchanged.

Examiner trap 28: Always decompose output change into area and yield.

MCQ 29

Which factor set best explains cropping-pattern choice?

A. Agro-climate, water, expected net returns, risk, technology and market access. B. Only the announced price of one crop. C. Only inherited cultural preference. D. Only farm size.

Answer: A.

Option-wise explanation:

- **A - Correct:** Crop allocation is a constrained risk-return decision embedded in ecology and institutions. The option states: Agro-climate, water, expected net returns, risk, technology and market access.
- **B - Incorrect:** Price alone omits costs, risk and sales. The option states: Only the announced price of one crop.
- **C - Incorrect:** Culture matters but is not exclusive. The option states: Only inherited cultural preference.
- **D - Incorrect:** Size interacts with many other determinants. The option states: Only farm size.

Examiner trap 29: A high price is not a complete profitability calculation.

MCQ 30

Which crop-category statement is most accurate?

A. Every food crop is non-commercial. B. Plantation crops are typically perennial estate crops, while horticulture includes fruits, vegetables, spices and flowers. C. All oilseeds fit one exclusive category in every classification. D. Tea is a seasonal field cereal.

Answer: B.

Option-wise explanation:

- **A - Incorrect:** Food crops can be market-oriented. The option states: Every food crop is non-commercial.
- **B - Correct:** The statement uses production-system and crop-use distinctions correctly. The option states: Plantation crops are typically perennial estate crops, while horticulture includes fruits, vegetables, spices and flowers.
- **C - Incorrect:** Classification purpose can place crops differently. The option states: All oilseeds fit one exclusive category in every classification.
- **D - Incorrect:** Tea is a perennial plantation crop. The option states: Tea is a seasonal field cereal.

Examiner trap 30: Crop categories are analytical and can overlap economically.

MCQ 31

Why is fragmentation distinct from small holding size?

A. Fragmentation measures only total owned hectares. B. It disappears automatically when land is leased informally. C. A holding can be small yet contiguous, or larger but split into costly scattered parcels. D. It affects neither irrigation nor machinery movement.

Answer: C.

Option-wise explanation:

- **A - Incorrect:** Total size omits spatial structure. The option states: Fragmentation measures only total owned hectares.
- **B - Incorrect:** Informal leasing may not reorganise plots. The option states: It disappears automatically when land is leased informally.
- **C - Correct:** Parcel number and location create costs independent of aggregate area. The option states: A holding can be small yet contiguous, or larger but split into costly scattered parcels.
- **D - Incorrect:** Scattering raises boundary and travel costs. The option states: It affects neither irrigation nor machinery movement.

Examiner trap 31: Size and parcel configuration require separate diagnosis.

MCQ 32

Which boundary statement is correct for this topic?

A. This topic should reproduce the complete MSP formula and buffer-stock rules. B. Land reform belongs entirely to Topic 12. C. Cropping systems should exclude all ecological analysis. D. Cropping incentives may mention procurement and sustainability, but detailed MSP/PDS belongs to Topic 12 and input-sustainability instruments to Topic 14.

Answer: D.

Option-wise explanation:

- **A - Incorrect:** Detailed procurement architecture is reserved for Topic 12. The option states: This topic should reproduce the complete MSP formula and buffer-stock rules.
- **B - Incorrect:** Land reform is the central owner here. The option states: Land reform belongs entirely to Topic 12.
- **C - Incorrect:** Ecological consequences are necessary, with deeper instruments deferred to Topic 14. The option states: Cropping systems should exclude all ecological analysis.
- **D - Correct:** The option preserves conceptual links without duplicating adjacent syllabus owners. The option states: Cropping incentives may mention procurement and sustainability, but detailed MSP/PDS belongs to Topic 12 and input-sustainability instruments to Topic 14.

Examiner trap 32: Cross-link adjacent topics without absorbing them.

PYQS AND ANSWER PRACTICE

VERIFIED ROUTED MAINS DEMANDS

The demands below are verified through the repository's audited official-paper routing ledgers. The solutions are original examiner-ready models, not official UPSC model answers.

2021 GS-III ROUTE - MARGINAL AND SMALL FARMERS

Demand: Explain how land reforms affected the conditions of marginal and small farmers.

Model solution: Intermediary abolition reduced rent-receiving layers, tenancy security strengthened the cultivator's claim to output, and ceilings created a route for asset redistribution. Operation Barga demonstrates how recording sharecroppers could convert a formal right into stronger bargaining and investment incentives. Consolidation could lower fragmentation costs, while ownership or secure tenancy could improve access to institutional benefits. However, outcomes depended on records, possession and complementary irrigation, credit and markets. Small parcel size, informal leases and weak mutation often limited benefits. Thus land reform improved conditions where rights became enforceable productive assets, not merely entries in legislation.

2023 GS-III ROUTE - OBJECTIVES, MEASURES AND CEILINGS

Demand: Discuss land-reform objectives, measures and the role of land ceilings.

Model solution: Land reform pursued distributive justice, cultivator security and productive reorganisation. Intermediary abolition removed rent-receiving layers; tenancy laws regulated rent, eviction and ownership claims; ceilings identified surplus for redistribution; consolidation reorganised scattered parcels; and record reform made rights enforceable. Ceilings directly addressed concentration, but family definitions, exemptions, benami transfers, litigation and weak possession narrowed distributable surplus. Redistribution could still remain unproductive without viable parcels and complementary services. Therefore ceilings should be judged through declaration, verification, acquisition, allotment and mutation, and as one component of the wider reform package.

2024 GS-III ROUTE - REGIONAL SUCCESS

Demand: Elaborate the factors behind successful land reforms in parts of India.

Model solution: Regional success rested on aligned law, political will, records, administration and beneficiary mobilisation. West Bengal's Operation Barga combined sharecropper recording with local mobilisation; Kerala's deeper tenancy reform reflected sustained political backing; and early Jammu and Kashmir restructuring arose in a distinct political setting. Accurate cadastral and tenancy records helped identify persons and parcels, while administrative follow-through converted declarations into possession and mutation. Beneficiary organisations improved reporting and enforcement. Yet these cases did not eliminate fragmentation, tiny holdings or employment constraints. They show that reform success is institutional and political, not the automatic result of statutory language.

OBJECTIVE PYQ ROUTING - KEY WITHHELD WHERE NOT LOCALLY VERIFIED

Year / paper	Routed official-paper demand	Key discipline
2018 Prelims GS-I Q3	NSSO 70th Round agricultural-household survey	Answer withheld pending official UPSC key.
2018 Prelims GS-I Q100	NPOP, APEDA and organic-State statements	Answer withheld pending official UPSC key.
2019 Prelims GS-I Q83	Kharif cultivated-area statements	Answer withheld pending official UPSC key.
2020 Prelims GS-I Q61	Public-investment categories in agriculture	Answer withheld pending official UPSC key.
2020 Prelims GS-I Q86	Black gram and green gram seasons	Answer withheld pending official UPSC key.
2021 Prelims GS-I Q57	Water-use comparison among major crops	Answer withheld pending official UPSC key.

ORIGINAL MAINS PRACTICE WITH MODEL SOLUTIONS

ORIGINAL MAINS 1 - 10 MARKS

Question: How did colonial land-revenue systems shape the agenda of post-Independence land reform? Answer in 150 words.

Model answer:

Colonial revenue settlements created distinct obstacles. The Permanent Settlement of 1793 placed zamindars between the State and cultivators, strengthening rent-receiving interests. Ryotwari dealt directly with recorded cultivators, but direct assessment did not guarantee affordable demand or secure title. Mahalwari made a village estate or co-sharer body responsible, tying revenue administration to local hierarchy.

Post-Independence reform therefore required several instruments. Intermediary abolition removed rent-receiving layers; tenancy laws regulated rent, eviction and ownership; ceilings addressed concentration; consolidation tackled scattered parcels; and records identified actual rights.

The causal lesson is that a revenue label did not determine one outcome. Regional variants, political power and record quality shaped each legacy. Reform had to alter both legal relationships and the administrative information through which they were enforced.

Native-body word count: 141 / 150.

Answer audit: Definition and thesis -> named constitutional/statutory evidence -> economic analysis -> qualification -> concise conclusion.

ORIGINAL MAINS 2 - 10 MARKS

Question: Explain why digital land records do not automatically create conclusive title. Answer in 150 words.

Model answer:

Digital records improve access, map consistency, mutation tracking and registration links. DILRMP 3.0 guidelines cover 2026-2031 and integrate textual records, cadastral maps and services. ULPIN identifies a georeferenced parcel, while SVAMITVA supports drone mapping and property cards in rural abadi areas.

These tools strengthen evidence, but title is a legal conclusion. Records may omit tenants, women, customary users or community rights; boundaries may be disputed; and State law determines a card's effect. Conclusive title additionally requires adjudication, notice, objections, continuous updating and rules allocating loss when the register is wrong.

Digitisation should therefore include participatory survey, accessible correction and independent dispute resolution. Technology reduces uncertainty, but treating a mapped record as indefeasible can formalise old errors.

Native-body word count: 136 / 150.

Answer audit: Definition and thesis -> named constitutional/statutory evidence -> economic analysis -> qualification -> concise conclusion.

ORIGINAL MAINS 3 - 15 MARKS

Question: Why did land reforms achieve deeper results in some Indian States than in others? Analyse in 250 words.

Model answer:

Land reform is principally implemented through State legislation, so a common national objective produced different field outcomes. Success required more than progressive statutory language.

First, political coalitions had to support cultivators against concentrated landed interests. West Bengal's Operation Barga combined sharecropper recording with mobilisation, making tenancy protection visible and enforceable. Kerala's comparatively deep tenancy and ceiling reforms similarly reflected sustained political backing. The early Big Landed Estates Abolition Act, 1950 in Jammu and Kashmir shows how timing and a distinct political setting could permit sharp restructuring.

Second, administrative information mattered. Updated records, cadastral maps and local verification identified tenants, holdings and surplus. Weak records enabled benami transfers, anticipatory partitions and exclusion of actual cultivators. Third, implementation required a chain from declaration to adjudication, possession, allotment and mutation; delay at any stage reduced the reform. Fourth, beneficiary organisation improved reporting and bargaining power. Fifth, complementary credit, irrigation, extension and market access determined whether redistributed or secured land became a viable productive asset.

Yet these examples should not be romanticised. Tenure security did not eliminate fragmentation, tiny holdings, labour underemployment or later agrarian stress. Regional success was therefore the product of aligned law, politics, records, administration and support services, not any single legal instrument.

Native-body word count: 221 / 250.

Answer audit: Definition and thesis -> named constitutional/statutory evidence -> economic analysis -> qualification -> concise conclusion.

ORIGINAL MAINS 4 - 15 MARKS

Question: Assess the achievements and limitations of India's Green Revolution. Answer in 250 words.

Model answer:

India's Green Revolution was an institutional package: semi-dwarf cereal varieties were combined with assured irrigation, fertiliser, credit, extension, seed systems and price-procurement support. This complementarity, rather than seed alone, drove the breakthrough from the mid-1960s.

Its principal achievement was a sustained rise in wheat and later rice yields and output. Larger marketed surplus strengthened domestic food availability, reduced chronic import dependence and expanded the policy capacity for

public food management. It also stimulated rural demand for pumps, fertiliser, machinery, transport and processing. ICAR, IARI, State agricultural universities, extension workers and farmers created an adaptive research-and-diffusion system.

However, the first gains were concentrated in irrigated Punjab, Haryana and western Uttar Pradesh and in wheat-rice systems. Rainfed regions, pulses and oilseeds benefited less initially. Unequal access to water, finance and machinery created distributional differences, while mechanisation altered labour demand unevenly.

Ecological costs accumulated through groundwater depletion, nutrient imbalance, salinity, pesticide pressure, residue burning and monoculture. Assured infrastructure and market incentives then created crop path dependence.

The balanced conclusion is not to reject productivity science but to redirect it. An evergreen-revolution strategy should combine climate-resilient varieties, balanced nutrients, water budgeting, diversified rotations, extension and viable alternative markets, preserving food security while reducing ecological and regional concentration.

Native-body word count: 222 / 250.

Answer audit: Definition and thesis -> named constitutional/statutory evidence -> economic analysis -> qualification -> concise conclusion.

ORIGINAL MAINS 5 - 20 MARKS

Question: Design a region-specific strategy for crop diversification in India. Answer in 250 words.

Model answer:

Crop diversification is a sustained change in crop or enterprise mix; it should improve risk-adjusted income and resource use rather than merely replace one crop administratively.

The starting point is agro-climatic fit. Dryland Deccan and arid regions can expand suitable millets, pulses and oilseeds; humid and hill regions may support horticulture, spices or plantation systems; irrigated north-western districts need gradual alternatives to water-intensive rice-wheat dependence. Soil, rainfall, aquifer stress and growing period should set the ecological boundary.

Farmers then require a viable risk-return proposition. Policy must compare expected net return, price volatility, labour, seed, credit, insurance and transition cost. Perishable horticulture needs grading, cold chains, processing and reliable buyers. Pulses and millets need quality seed, extension, processing and sustained consumer demand. Farmer organisations and contract safeguards can aggregate produce without transferring land.

Cropping-system design should use rotations, legumes and intercropping to improve soil and spread biological risk. Digital advisories and climate-resilient varieties can support decisions, but they cannot replace physical water management or markets.

Procurement incentives influence crop choice, although detailed MSP and food-stock design belong to Topic 12. Diversification must remain voluntary and sequenced: protect staple security, build alternative value chains, pilot locally and scale only where farm income, water use and resilience improve together.

Native-body word count: 225 / 250.

Answer audit: Definition and thesis -> named constitutional/statutory evidence -> economic analysis -> qualification -> concise conclusion.

ORIGINAL MAINS 6 - 20 MARKS

Question: Propose an integrated agrarian-reform architecture linking land, technology and structural transformation. Answer in 250 words.

Model answer:

An integrated agrarian strategy must connect secure rights with productive technology and safe economic mobility.

First, States should update tenancy and leasing laws so owners can lease without losing title and cultivators receive written operational rights. Mutation drives must record women, tenants and lawful successors, while participatory mapping must protect tribal, customary and common rights. DILRMP, ULPIN and SVAMITVA can improve information, but objections, adjudication and State-law recognition must precede any claim of conclusive title.

Second, holdings need workable organisation. Consolidation, voluntary pooling, custom-hiring services and producer organisations can reduce fragmentation costs without compulsory ownership concentration. Beneficiaries of redistribution require irrigation, soil improvement, credit, extension and market access.

Third, technology policy should move from a uniform input package to location-specific sustainable productivity. Climate-resilient seed, balanced nutrients, water budgeting, rotations and diversified crop-livestock systems should address yield gaps without repeating groundwater and monoculture stress.

Fourth, structural transformation needs land and labour mobility together. Secure leasing can allow households to take non-farm work while retaining ownership, and active cultivators can assemble operational land. Skills, rural enterprises and social protection must prevent mobility from becoming distress exit.

The governing principle is coordinated federalism: States retain the central land role, national institutions support research and interoperable records, and outcomes are judged by rights, productivity, income, resilience and inclusion together.

Native-body word count: 234 / 250.

Answer audit: Definition and thesis -> named constitutional/statutory evidence -> economic analysis -> qualification
-> concise conclusion.